

□ The Curriculum

Our aim is to fulfil the potential of every child in our care.

We regard these school years (from the ages 3-11) as forming the base on which our pupils will build their future education. We therefore aim to give our pupils as broad an education as possible.

We are preparing our children not only for their senior schools but also future life skills.

Aims of the Curriculum

At Westward we undertake to:

- Have high expectations of the children and ourselves.
- Raise levels of attainment for all pupils, enabling them to achieve their personal best.
- Develop their skills of reading, writing and mathematics.
- Develop confident, disciplined and enquiring learners who are able to make informed choices.
- Foster a love of learning.
- Foster self-esteem and personal responsibility, linked to respect for the needs and feelings of others.
- Facilitate considerate and positive relationships between all members of the school community.
- Ensure equal opportunities in relation to gender, race, individual needs and/or disabilities and beliefs.
- Value and respect all cultures.
- Provide a safe, happy work place.
- Provide a thoughtful attitude towards the immediate and wider environment.

Subjects

The curriculum followed at Westward is suitably broad and balanced for both boys and girls with Drama, Music, PE, Computing and French all taught by specialist teachers.

Subjects covered:

- English
- Maths
- Science
- Computing
- French
- Drama
- Music
- Art
- Geography
- History
- PE (Physical Education)
- PSHE (Personal Social & Health Education) and Citizenship
- Spiritual, Moral, Social and Cultural Development

The Early Years Foundation Stage (EYFS) which underpins the curriculum in the Nursery and Reception classes is distinct in its identity. The curriculum, by which we mean everything that the children do within school, is planned in accordance with the Early Years Foundation Stage Framework (EYFS) 2012.

“Setting the standard for Learning, Development and Care for children from birth to five.”

The time table is designed to give a good balance between the academic subjects and creative subjects such as Drama, Art, Design and Technology, Sport and Music.

The development of skills in English and Mathematics are of prime importance. Structured reading schemes are used; spelling, handwriting, grammar and comprehension are taught to all age groups.

The mathematics curriculum incorporates the guidelines of the National Curriculum and includes traditional skills such as problem solving and logic, developing investigational mathematics as well as traditional concepts.

Science and Computing lessons are structured to encourage the children to explore, investigate and find out about the world themselves. Reasoning encourages clear thinking and logical deduction. History and Geography introduce the wider world, both past and present. French lessons are taught from Year 3.

Throughout the school PSHE and Citizenship is taught as a discreet subject twice a week by the class teacher and is also delivered through subject teaching, assemblies, church services,

charity/community involvement, outings, class roles and responsibilities and guest speakers.
(See the PSHE policy for more information)